# Is eSIM Going To Replace The Plain Old SIM Card?


**The introduction of eSIM (embedded SIM) has helped in the growth and transformation of the Internet of Things (IoT) based devices to a large extent by allowing manufacturers to build a new range of products for global deployment. eSIMs have brought a new experience and advantages over ordinary SIM cards. However, there's still a lot to explore and cover in this field to tap the maximum benefits**

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The life of mobile phones probably began with SIM cards. Today, most of the mobile activities are carried out through SIM cards. It is also true that SIM cards have greater potential for online activities like the Internet, telephony, multimedia, etc. With the launch of Apple Watch 3, the term 'eSIM' started gaining popularity. And now, Google's Pixel 2 is the first phone to use this technology.

eSIM simply means an embedded SIM, whereas SIM is an abbreviation for Subscriber Identity Module. So, eSIM (also known as electronic SIM) is an embedded Subscriber Identity Module. It is actually built into the phone's mainboard. It is rewritable with the help of SIM card service providers, regardless of what type of networks they use.

Since eSIM is a digital SIM, it allows you to activate a cellular plan from your carrier without having to use the replacable physical SIM.

eSIM is the only globally-backed remote SIM specification for consumer devices. This universal approach will help in the growth of the Internet of Things (IoT) based devices to a large extent by allowing manufacturers to build a new range of products for global deployment based on this common embedded SIM architecture. This article covers how eSIM can bring new experiences and offer better advantages over ordinary SIM cards.

## Progress made in eSIM

Since 2018, the GSMA (Global System Mobile Application) is working with leading mobile operators, device makers, and SIM manufacturers worldwide for developing universal standards for eSIMs that can be deployed globally. The standard contains a wide range of features, including an option for eSIMs to be locked.

2nd World eSIM 2018 Summit and Mobile World Congress, which took place in Berlin in February 2018, stressed upon a greater impact of eSIMs on consumer IoT